

Ellan Vannin Wealth Management

Private Equity Infrastructure Division

Mannin Coffee Company

A Northern England Community Coffee House Network

Investment Proposal

Executive Summary

Ellan Vannin Wealth Management (EVWM) proposes the creation of **Mannin Coffee Company**, a network of **100 affordable premium coffee houses** across Northern England.

The objective is simple:

To become the lowest-cost, highest-quality coffee chain in Britain.

Rather than competing with boutique cafés or premium coffee chains on luxury finishes, Mannin Coffee will compete on:

- High-quality coffee
- Honest pricing
- Large open interiors
- Excellent food
- Comfortable seating
- Fast Wi-Fi
- Long opening hours
- Convenient locations

The concept is built around the belief that coffee shops are becoming an essential part of modern civic infrastructure—a place where people work, study, meet, relax and spend time regardless of income.

Investment Philosophy

Britain has become an expensive place to buy coffee.

Many national chains now charge between **£3.50 and £5.00** for standard drinks, while independent cafés often charge even more for speciality products.

Mannin Coffee aims to reverse this trend through scale, operational simplicity and efficient building design.

The objective is to offer:

- Premium coffee from professional espresso machines
- Freshly prepared food
- Comfortable surroundings

at prices accessible to everyone.

Brand Position

Mannin Coffee draws inspiration from:

- Industrial Northern architecture
- Converted warehouse cafés
- Scandinavian simplicity
- The Isle of Man's reputation for quality and independence

The interiors would feel open, practical and welcoming rather than luxurious.

Design Philosophy

Every Mannin Coffee would occupy large premises where possible.

Instead of small high-street cafés with limited seating, stores would typically occupy former:

- warehouses
- retail units
- supermarkets
- industrial buildings
- mills
- railway arches
- commercial premises

Average floor space:

5,000–8,000 sq ft

This provides significantly more seating than a conventional coffee shop while keeping fit-out costs relatively low through reuse of existing structures.

Interior Style

The design language would be deliberately simple.

Features include:

- exposed brick
- polished concrete floors
- exposed steelwork
- timber tables
- large communal benches
- comfortable armchairs
- extensive natural light
- plentiful electrical sockets
- high-speed Wi-Fi

The emphasis is on durability and functionality rather than expensive finishes.

The Customer Experience

Customers are encouraged to stay.

The cafés become places for:

- studying
- remote working
- informal meetings
- reading
- socialising
- family visits
- community events

Large premises mean seating pressure is reduced, allowing customers to remain without constant pressure to vacate tables.

Product Strategy

Coffee

Professional espresso coffee.

Menu:

- Espresso
- Americano
- Flat White
- Cappuccino
- Latte
- Mocha
- Filter Coffee

- Tea
- Hot Chocolate

Target pricing:

Product	Price
Espresso	£1.20
Americano	£1.50
Flat White	£1.80
Latte	£1.90
Cappuccino	£1.90
Filter Coffee	£1.20

The objective is to offer some of the lowest coffee prices among national chains while maintaining speciality-grade beans.

Food

Fresh food prepared daily.

Menu:

Breakfast

- bacon sandwiches
- sausage sandwiches
- porridge
- pastries

Lunch

- sandwiches
- toasties
- soups
- salads
- jacket potatoes

Bakery

- cakes
- traybakes
- cookies
- scones

Target pricing:

Average meal:

£3–5

Store Rollout

Phase One

20 stores

Cities:

- Leeds
 - Sheffield
 - York
 - Hull
 - Liverpool
 - Manchester
 - Newcastle
 - Preston
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Phase Two

Expansion to

50 stores

Phase Three

100 stores

Covering every major town and city across Northern England.

Operating Model

The business focuses on:

- high customer volumes
- rapid service
- simple menu
- efficient purchasing
- central roasting
- regional food distribution

The warehouse format allows larger customer numbers with lower occupancy costs per seat than smaller city-centre cafés.

Capital Requirement

Rather than developing expensive flagship cafés, Mannin Coffee would lease and refurbish existing commercial premises using a standardised fit-out.

Component	Cost
Store fit-out	£70,000
Coffee equipment	£20,000
Kitchen equipment	£10,000
Furniture	£10,000
Initial stock	£10,000

Total per store

£120,000

Network Investment

100 stores

£12 million

Central infrastructure:

- coffee roasting
- logistics
- management
- IT systems

would be developed incrementally from operating cash flow and external commercial partnerships rather than requiring substantial upfront investment.

Operating Economics

Illustrative mature store performance:

Metric	Annual
Revenue	£300,000
Operating margin	10%
Operating profit	£30,000

Network Performance

100 stores

Annual turnover

£30 million

Operating profit

£3 million

Employment

Average staff:

10 per store

100 stores

=

1,000 direct jobs

Additional employment:

- logistics
- roasting
- maintenance
- administration

Total:

Approximately

1,150 jobs

Regional Supply Chain

Where commercially practical, procurement would prioritise suppliers from Northern England:

- Yorkshire dairies
- Lancashire bakeries
- Cumbrian food producers
- Northern engineering firms
- British furniture manufacturers

This approach supports regional economic activity while reducing transport distances.

Social Impact

The proposal is intended to create affordable public spaces in town centres at a time when many communities have experienced declining high streets and rising living costs.

Expected benefits include:

- affordable refreshments
 - accessible meeting places
 - support for students and freelancers
 - revitalisation of vacant commercial units
 - increased footfall for neighbouring businesses
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Investment Case

Capital investment:

£12 million

Illustrative network turnover:

£30 million per annum

Illustrative operating profit:

£3 million per annum

This represents an operating return of approximately **25% on the original capital investment**, assuming the network reaches maturity and achieves its target performance.

Strategic Vision

Mannin Coffee Company is not intended to be another premium coffee chain.

It is designed as a piece of modern civic infrastructure.

By occupying large, underused commercial buildings with a low-cost warehouse aesthetic, offering Britain's most affordable professionally made coffee, and providing generous seating without unnecessary luxury, the network aims to restore the coffee house as a genuinely public space.

For Ellan Vannin Wealth Management, the investment represents a scalable regional enterprise with relatively low capital requirements, straightforward operations and the potential to regenerate high streets while delivering attractive long-term commercial returns.